NHMEC Wellness Herbalist Diploma

Module 2: The Holistic P.E.N. Way™ Framework

Professional Registration Diploma

Estimated Completion Time: 20–25 Hours

Module Overview

The Wellness Herbalist understands that wellness extends beyond physical health. True wellness is achieved when the whole person is considered—spirit, soul, and body.

The Holistic P.E.N. Way™ is the signature educational framework of the Natural Health Ministries Education Center (NHMEC). It provides a structured method for organizing wellness education while recognizing the interconnectedness of spiritual beliefs, emotional well-being, lifestyle habits, nutrition, and herbal support.

Rather than viewing wellness as a collection of symptoms or isolated body systems, the Holistic P.E.N. Way™ encourages students to consider the entire person. This approach promotes individualized wellness education and helps the Wellness Herbalist create comprehensive wellness support plans that honor both biblical principles and holistic stewardship.

Learning Objectives

Upon completion of this module, students will be able to:

- Explain the philosophy of the Holistic P.E.N. Way™.
- Describe the three pillars: Perspective, Essence, and Nutrition.
- Identify factors that influence whole-person wellness.
- Develop a Holistic P.E.N. Way™ wellness framework.
- Integrate previous knowledge into a comprehensive wellness model.
- Recognize the importance of individualized wellness education.
- Apply ethical principles while developing educational wellness plans.

Required Reading

Primary Text

The Wellness Herbalist: A Guide to Family, Community, Kitchen, and Seasonal Wellness

Read:

- Chapter 7 – The Holistic P.E.N. Way™ of Wellness
- Chapter 8 – Becoming a Wellness Herbalist

Companion Manual

Review the following sections from the Wellness Herbalist Companion Manual:

- The Holistic P.E.N. Way™
- Spiritual Nourishment
- Mental Health
- Nutrition of the Body
- Holistic Herb, Food & Supplement List
- Method Model

Required Videos

- Holistic P.E.N. Way™ Overview
- Wellness Herbalist Protocol Presentation
- Spiritual Nourishment Lesson
- Mental Health Lesson
- Nutrition Lesson

Understanding the Holistic P.E.N. Way™

The Holistic P.E.N. Way™ recognizes that wellness is influenced by every area of a person's life.

Rather than asking only:

"What herb should I use?"

The Wellness Herbalist also asks:

- What is occurring spiritually?

- What emotional stressors exist?
- What nutritional deficiencies may be present?
- What lifestyle habits influence wellness?
- What environmental factors contribute?
- What seasonal influences should be considered?

This broader perspective allows the Wellness Herbalist to educate clients using a comprehensive wellness model.

The Three Pillars

P – Perspective (Spirit)

Perspective focuses on spiritual wellness and worldview.

Areas to Consider

- Faith
- Prayer
- Hope
- Purpose
- Identity
- Gratitude
- Worship
- Forgiveness
- Biblical principles

Reflection Questions

- Does the individual have hope?
- What sources of stress affect spiritual well-being?
- What role does faith play in their daily life?

E – Essence (Mind & Soul)

Essence represents the emotional and mental aspects of wellness.

Areas to Consider

- Emotional health
- Relationships
- Stress
- Sleep
- Habits

- Coping skills
- Joy
- Peace
- Personal growth

Reflection Questions

- What daily stressors exist?
- How does the individual respond to adversity?
- What habits support or hinder wellness?

N – Nutrition (Body)

Nutrition focuses on physical stewardship.

Areas to Consider

- Diet
- Hydration
- Exercise
- Herbal support
- Rest
- Digestion
- Seasonal wellness
- Environmental exposures
- Daily routines

Reflection Questions

- Are nutritional needs being met?
- Are herbs being used safely?
- Does the lifestyle support wellness?

Integration

The three pillars should never be viewed independently.

For example:

A person experiencing fatigue may also be experiencing:

Perspective

- Loss of purpose
- Spiritual discouragement

Essence

- Chronic stress
- Poor sleep
- Emotional exhaustion

Nutrition

- Inadequate protein intake
- Dehydration
- Mineral deficiencies
- Poor digestion
- Lack of movement

The Wellness Herbalist seeks to educate the individual in all three areas rather than focusing on only one.

Individualized Wellness

Every individual is unique.

Factors influencing wellness include:

- Age
- Family history
- Occupation
- Environment
- Lifestyle
- Activity level
- Seasonal changes
- Dietary preferences
- Personal goals
- Spiritual beliefs

Because of these differences, no two educational wellness plans should be identical.

The Wellness Planning Process

The NHMEC Wellness Herbalist follows a simple educational framework:

Step 1 – Observe

Gather information through observation and conversation.

Step 2 – Identify Wellness Priorities

Determine which wellness areas would benefit from education and support.

Step 3 – Organize

Categorize findings using the Perspective, Essence, and Nutrition framework.

Step 4 – Educate

Provide educational resources related to herbs, nutrition, lifestyle, and seasonal wellness.

Step 5 – Encourage

Support the individual's wellness journey through continued education and accountability.

Case Example

Client Profile

Sarah is a 47-year-old teacher who reports low energy, poor sleep, increased stress, and difficulty preparing healthy meals due to a busy schedule.

Perspective

- Feels spiritually disconnected.
- Rarely spends time in prayer or personal reflection.

Essence

- High work-related stress.
- Inconsistent sleep.
- Limited time for self-care.

Nutrition

- Frequently skips breakfast.
- Drinks little water.
- Limited intake of fresh fruits and vegetables.
- Rarely prepares herbal teas despite prior knowledge.

Educational Priorities

- Establish a consistent morning routine.
- Increase hydration.
- Introduce simple kitchen herbal practices.
- Encourage stress-reducing activities.
- Develop a realistic weekly meal plan.
- Reintroduce daily devotional time.

Reflection

Consider how the Holistic P.E.N. Way™ changes the way wellness is approached.

Reflect on the following:

- Why is whole-person wellness important?
- Which pillar do you believe is most often neglected in today's society?
- How can a Wellness Herbalist encourage lasting lifestyle changes?

Record your responses in your Wellness Journal.

Module Assignment

Assignment 1

Build Your Holistic P.E.N. Way™ Framework

Create a visual framework illustrating the relationship between:

- Perspective
- Essence
- Nutrition

Include examples of wellness factors that belong within each category.

Assignment 2

Case Study

Using the sample client provided in this module, develop an educational wellness plan organized under:

- Perspective

- Essence
- Nutrition

Your plan should include educational recommendations only and remain within the Wellness Herbalist scope of practice.

Assignment 3

Personal Wellness Assessment

Complete a Holistic P.E.N. Way™ self-assessment.

Evaluate your own wellness in each of the three pillars and identify three personal goals for growth during this diploma program.

Vocabulary

Define the following terms:

- Holistic
- Stewardship
- Perspective
- Essence
- Nutrition
- Lifestyle
- Wellness Education
- Observation
- Individualization
- Integration

Discussion Questions

1. How does the Holistic P.E.N. Way™ differ from conventional health models?
2. Why is individualized wellness education important?
3. How can spiritual wellness influence physical wellness?
4. Why should emotional wellness be considered when discussing nutrition?
5. What are the benefits of organizing wellness education using the P.E.N. framework?

Module Quiz

25 Multiple Choice Questions

Topics include:

- Holistic P.E.N. Way™ philosophy
- Perspective
- Essence
- Nutrition
- Whole-person wellness
- Wellness planning process
- Individualized wellness education
- Scope of practice

Passing Score: 80%

Students who do not achieve a passing score may review the material and retake the assessment.

Preparing for Module 3

In Module 3, students will learn how to conduct advanced wellness observations and organize information into professional educational wellness plans using the Holistic P.E.N. Way™ framework.